

SECURITY WATCH

COVID-19 scams on the rise

The high volume of phishing emails and other security threats relating to COVID-19 has now become the largest coalescence of cyber attacks surrounding a single theme. As workplaces have shutdown and people have begun working from home, one in three executives have reported a spike in cyberthreats to their systems, as per a CNBC survey. In the same survey, one organisation reported a whopping 40 percent rise in cyber scams. As per a report from Digital Shadows, scammers are allegedly posing as the WHO, the Centres for Disease Control and Prevention and John Hopkins University in an attempt to swindle money, account information and login details. Such emails often provoke users into clicking links that download malware which then steals sensitive information. A Check Point report confirmed that the darknet is seeing increased instances of advertising hacking tools. However, agencies in the US such as the FBI and FTC are attempting to crack down on the barrage of scams.

MOBILE WATCH

LG V60 ThinQ

LG announced the V60 ThinQ 5G featuring 5G connectivity, an upgraded camera and dual screen capabilities. The second screen is an accessory which can be attached to the primary display and folded over like a foldable display. Both screens feature 6.8-inch FHD+ P-OLED panels. The secondary screen also comes with a cover display which can show information such as the time, notifications and more. The phone packs a 64MP primary lens, a 13MP wide angle lens and a ToF (Time of Flight) sensor for depth information on the back. Users can also shoot 8K video on the rear camera. The front camera is a standard 10MP lens. Sporting a massive 5000 mAh battery, the V60 ThinQ is powered by the flagship Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 processor and a Snapdragon X55 5G modem for 5G connectivity. The phone also comes with a generous 8GB of RAM and 128 or 256GB internal memory options which is expandable up to a whopping 2TB by microSD.



APP WATCH

Audius Music



A new rival to Soundcloud, Audius Music, a new music streaming and free hosting service, has made its way onto the Android and iOS app stores. The app is also backed by popular artists such as deadmau5 and more. While Soundcloud has stood the test of time and remained popular over the years, users were complaining about the exorbitant hosting costs, the content takedowns and relatively slow user interface. Audius is attempting to differentiate itself by offer-

ing a place for new artists, where they will earn 90 percent of the revenue generated by their music, as per TechCrunch. It also promises absolutely no music takedowns and music creators can upload their tracks for free. Audius isn't just a mobile app or website, but it is an open-source protocol built on the blockchain. However, users do not need to be well-versed in blockchain to sign up and upload/browse music.

Audius works by decentralising the music uploaded on its platform across independently-operated nodes. The platform distributes its very own tokens to artists and node operators. We see some of them grab at the opportunity to get these crypto-

tokens since if the service really does become popular, the value of the tokens could skyrocket. Audius is also free for listening at high quality (320kbps). However, artists cannot make money on

the platform as yet. Nevertheless, plans are already underway to allow artists to mandate their users to listen to ads to subscribe on a monthly basis to their channel. As we mentioned above, the company intends to have 90 percent of the revenue go to the

artists while 10 percent will go to the node operators. The good thing about Audius is that unlike other blockchain apps, signup is quite simple. All that is needed is an email address or a Twitter sign-in.



Privy



Privy is a private social media app just for your friends and family. It alleviates users from having to deal with stranger friend requests, advertisements and other such social media aggravations.

SayCheese



Ever wish you had a remote control for clicking those perfect group shots? With SayCheese, you can, by connecting two phones and making one the remote control. You can see the viewfinder and adjust focus on the other phone as well!

Vimeo Create



Vimeo Create is a video creator and editor which features a bunch of custom video templates that simplify the process. The platform also has a stock library of free-to-use videos and commercially-licensed music.